

AP[®] English Literature and Composition Practice Exam

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ENGLISH LITERATURE AND COMPOSITION

SECTION I

Time—1 hour

Directions: This section consists of selections from literary works and questions on their content, form, and style. After reading each passage or poem, choose the best answer to each question and then fill in the corresponding circle on the answer sheet.

Note: Pay particular attention to the requirements of questions that contain the words NOT, LEAST, or EXCEPT.

Questions 1-11. Read the following poem carefully before you choose your answers.

Song

Sweetest love, I do not go
For weariness of thee,
Nor in hope the world can show
A fitter love for me;
5 But since that I
Must die at last, 'tis best
To use myself in jest,
Thus by feigned deaths to die.

Yesternight the sun went hence,
10 And yet is here today;
He hath no desire nor sense,
Nor half so short a way:
Then fear not me,
But believe that I shall make
15 Speedier journeys, since I take
More wings and spurs than he.

O how feeble is man's power,
That if good fortune fall,
Cannot add another hour,
20 Nor a lost hour recall!
But come bad chance,
And we join to it our strength,
And we teach it art and length,
Itself o'er us to advance.

25 When thou sigh'st, thou sigh'st not wind,
But sigh'st my soul away;
When thou weep'st, unkindly kind,
My life's blood doth decay.
It cannot be
30 That thou lov'st me, as thou say'st,
If in thine my life thou waste;
Thou art the best of me.

Let not thy divining heart
Forethink me any ill;
35 Destiny may take thy part,
And may thy fears fulfill;
But think that we
Are but turned aside to sleep;
They who one another keep
40 Alive, ne'er parted be.

(1633)

- The primary intention of the speaker is to
 - reassure and comfort his beloved
 - soothe his own breaking heart
 - chastise his beloved for ignoring his attentions
 - help his beloved to understand the finality of death
 - advise his beloved about the misfortunes of love
- Lines 1-4 are best understood as an attempt by the speaker to
 - dispel mistaken concerns
 - undermine a romantic bond
 - offer an excuse for repeated wrongdoings
 - acknowledge some unfair allegations
 - explain the reasons for a difficult decision
- In comparing himself to the Sun in the second stanza, the speaker makes all the following points EXCEPT:
 - The Sun cannot feel as he can.
 - The Sun returns, and so will he.
 - The Sun lacks his passion.
 - The Sun is slower paced than he will be.
 - The Sun has a shorter distance to travel than he does.

4. The “wings and spurs” mentioned in line 16 are best understood to represent
 - (A) the speaker’s desires to allay his anxieties about death
 - (B) desire for the beloved that the speaker carries with him
 - (C) jokes by the speaker regarding his own mortality
 - (D) the beloved’s criticisms of the speaker’s previous behavior
 - (E) the beloved’s apprehensions about the faithfulness of the speaker
5. The observation in the third stanza is that
 - (A) good fortune and bad fortune are equally to be expected in our experience
 - (B) good fortune has more impact on our lives than bad fortune
 - (C) good fortune cannot be prolonged, but we help bad fortune to endure
 - (D) good fortune should be recollected in times of bad fortune
 - (E) good fortune is what we hope for when bad fortune strikes
6. In lines 25-28, the speaker’s images suggest that
 - (A) the speaker is profoundly affected by the beloved’s every emotion
 - (B) the speaker sighs and weeps for the beloved
 - (C) the beloved perceives and struggles to accept that the speaker is near death
 - (D) the beloved has betrayed the speaker
 - (E) the beloved is a better person than the speaker
7. Lines 27-28 contain an instance of
 - (A) anaphora
 - (B) malapropism
 - (C) non sequitur
 - (D) oxymoron
 - (E) ellipsis
8. In line 31, “thine” refers to
 - (A) the beloved’s blood
 - (B) the beloved’s love
 - (C) the beloved’s life
 - (D) the speaker’s life
 - (E) the speaker’s blood
9. Lines 33-34 suggest that the speaker’s beloved
 - (A) has spiritual aspirations
 - (B) worries about future events
 - (C) keeps secrets
 - (D) is remote and unapproachable
 - (E) is manipulative
10. Lines 35-36 suggest that destiny may
 - (A) take the beloved’s life
 - (B) grant the beloved’s wishes
 - (C) act in the beloved’s stead
 - (D) carry out what the beloved anticipates
 - (E) subvert the beloved’s fears
11. The form of the poem may best be described as a
 - (A) lyric in free verse
 - (B) ballad without a refrain
 - (C) series of abbreviated sonnets
 - (D) series of octaves with fixed metrical and rhyming patterns
 - (E) series of enjambed stanzas with irregular meter but regular rhyming

Questions 12-23. Read the following passage carefully before you choose your answers.

Line The progress of the friendship between Catherine
and Isabella was quick as its beginning had been
warm, and they passed so rapidly through every
gradation of increasing tenderness, that there was
5 shortly no fresh proof of it to be given to their
friends or themselves. They called each other by
their Christian name, were always arm in arm when
they walked, pinned up each other's train for the
dance, and were not to be divided in the set; and if
10 a rainy morning deprived them of other enjoyments,
they were still resolute in meeting in defiance of
wet and dirt, and shut themselves up, to read novels
together. Yes, novels;—for I will not adopt that
ungenerous and impolitic custom so common with
15 novel writers, of degrading by their contemptuous
censure the very performances, to the number of
which they are themselves adding—joining with
their greatest enemies in bestowing the harshest
epithets on such works, and scarcely ever permitting
20 them to be read by their own heroine, who, if she
accidentally take up a novel, is sure to turn over its
insipid pages with disgust. Alas! if the heroine of
one novel be not patronized by the heroine of another,
from whom can she expect protection and regard?
25 I cannot approve of it. Let us leave it to the Reviewers
to abuse such effusions of fancy at their leisure, and
over every new novel to talk in threadbare strains of
the trash with which the press now groans. Let us not
desert one another; we are an injured body. Although
30 our productions have afforded more extensive and
unaffected pleasure than those of any other literary
corporation in the world, no species of composition
has been so much decried. From pride, ignorance, or
fashion, our foes are almost as many as our readers.
35 And while the abilities of the nine-hundredth abridger
of the History of England, or of the man who collects
and publishes in a volume some dozen lines of
Milton, Pope, and Prior, with a paper from the
Spectator, and a chapter from Sterne, are eulogized
40 by a thousand pens,—there seems almost a general
wish of decrying the capacity and undervaluing
the labour of the novelist, and of slighting the
performances which have only genius, wit, and taste
to recommend them. 'I am no novel reader—I seldom
45 look into novels—Do not imagine that *I* often read
novels—It is really very well for a novel.'—Such
is the common cant.—'And what are you reading,
Miss—?' 'Oh! it is only a novel!' replies the young
lady; while she lays down her book with affected

50 indifference, or momentary shame.—'It is only
Cecilia, or Camilla, or Belinda;' or, in short, only
some work in which the greatest powers of the mind
are displayed, in which the most thorough knowledge
of human nature, the happiest delineation of its
55 varieties, the liveliest effusions of wit and humour are
conveyed to the world in the best chosen language.

(1818)

12. The absence of "fresh proof" (line 5) suggests which of the following about Catherine and Isabella?
- (A) Their friendship had developed fully.
 - (B) Their relationship was puzzling to outsiders.
 - (C) Their feelings toward one another were beginning to change.
 - (D) They gave no outward sign of their mutual affection.
 - (E) They constantly sought reassurance from one another.
13. In context, the statement "Yes, novels" (line 13) does all of the following EXCEPT
- (A) call attention to the subject of a digression
 - (B) introduce a commentary about a practice common to writers of fiction
 - (C) mark a shift from third-person to first-person narration
 - (D) imply that the previous sentence may contain surprising information
 - (E) suggest that an earlier observation is inaccurate
14. From line 13 on, the narrator is speaking primarily as
- (A) a defensive reader
 - (B) the heroine of a novel
 - (C) an indignant reviewer
 - (D) a novelist
 - (E) an editor

15. The statement in lines 22-24 (“Alas . . . regard”) produces its effect primarily by
- (A) describing a technical goal of many novelists
 - (B) overstating the extent of an aesthetic problem
 - (C) implying a type of conspiracy among female authors
 - (D) expressing disapproval of the public’s taste in literature
 - (E) imagining a kind of sisterhood among fictional protagonists
16. In line 23, “patronized” is best interpreted to mean
- (A) condescended to
 - (B) taken as a model
 - (C) lionized
 - (D) scrutinized
 - (E) supported
17. The narrator’s attitude toward “Reviewers” (line 25) is best characterized as
- (A) appreciative
 - (B) conciliatory
 - (C) dispassionate
 - (D) scornful
 - (E) fearful
18. The narrator uses the word “body” (line 29) primarily to
- (A) exalt the status of a group
 - (B) reinforce a feeling of community
 - (C) justify a concern for self-interest
 - (D) emphasize a physical danger
 - (E) demand immediate help
19. All of the following are used to refer to novels EXCEPT
- (A) “performances” (line 16)
 - (B) “effusions of fancy” (line 26)
 - (C) “strains” (line 27)
 - (D) “trash” (line 28)
 - (E) “productions” (line 30)
20. The narrator suggests that the abridgements and collections referred to in lines 35-40 are
- (A) widely read
 - (B) aesthetically pleasing
 - (C) excessively praised
 - (D) factually inaccurate
 - (E) stylistically pretentious
21. In context, the friendship between Catherine and Isabella is best understood as a
- (A) reaffirmation of wisdom typically expressed in popular novels
 - (B) reflection of the narrator’s hostility toward other novelists
 - (C) contrast to the lack of loyalty novelists show to one another
 - (D) parallel to the relationship between novelists and reviewers
 - (E) protest against the lack of realism in novels
22. Which of the following best states the narrator’s central point about novelists?
- (A) They are unfairly represented in popular fiction.
 - (B) They inappropriately malign their own profession.
 - (C) They are less talented than writers of nonfiction.
 - (D) They present an unrealistic vision of ordinary life.
 - (E) They place their own interests above those of readers.
23. Taken as a whole, the passage is best characterized as
- (A) an elaborate joke
 - (B) an impassioned defense
 - (C) a philosophical inquiry
 - (D) a personal attack
 - (E) a scholarly argument

Questions 24-32. Read the following passage carefully before you choose your answers.

The following is an excerpt from a novel set on the Caribbean island of Trinidad.

Line It must have been about in Third Standard that
Helen came into existence. For by then I used to look
forward to the library van on Saturdays with the
greatest of impatience, having usually read the
5 two books by Monday morning.

Books transported you always into the familiar
solidity of chimneys and apple trees, the enviable
normality of real Girls and Boys who went a-
sleighting and built snowmen, ate potatoes, not rice,
10 went about in socks and shoes from morning until
night and called things by their proper names, never
saying ‘washicong’ for plimsoll* or ‘crapaud’ when
they meant a frog. Books transported you always into
Reality and Rightness, which were to be found
15 Abroad.

Thus it was that I fashioned Helen, my double.
She was my age and height. She spent the summer
holidays at the sea-side with her aunt and uncle who
had a delightful orchard with apple trees and pear
20 trees in which sang chaffinches and blue tits, and
where one could wander on terms of the closest
familiarity with cowslips and honeysuckle. Helen
loved to visit her Granny for then they sat by the
fireside and had tea with delicious scones and home-
made strawberry jam. . . . Helen entered and ousted
25 all the other characters in the unending serial that I
had been spinning for Toddan and Doolarie from time
immemorial.

At one time I took to putting on shoes the
30 moment I woke up on mornings and not removing
them again until bedtime. This caused some hilarity
in the household—‘What happen, Ma-Davis, yu
really takin’-in with ol’-age, eh?’ enquired Mikey
solicitously. But when one day I started to put on
35 socks to go to the shop, Tantie was not amused.
‘Look, Madam, when yu start to wash yu own
clothes then yu could start to play the monkey—you
ever put-on socks to go down in the shop? What it is
take yu at-all?’

40 I loved rainy mornings, for then I could pretend it
was winter as I left for school bundled up in an old
jacket.

Helen wasn’t even my double. No, she couldn’t be
called my double. She was the Proper Me. And me, I
45 was her shadow hovering about in incompleteness.

For doubleness, or this particular kind of
doubleness, was a thing to be taken for granted. Why,
the whole of life was like a piece of cloth, with a
rightside and a wrongside. Just as there was a way
50 you spoke and a way you wrote, so there was the
daily existence which you led, which of course
amounted only to marking time and makeshift, for
there was the Proper daily round, not necessarily more
agreeable, simply the valid one, the course of which
55 encompassed things like warming yourself before a
fire and having tea at four o’clock; there were the
human types who were your neighbours and
guardians and playmates—but you were all marginal
together, for there were the beings whose validity
60 loomed at you out of every book, every picture.

*A plimsoll is a canvas sneaker.

From *Crick Crack, Monkey* by Merle Hodge, copyright © 1970 by
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24. The books the narrator gets from the library van are significant to her because they
- (A) transport her to an earlier era
 - (B) require her to read at an advanced level
 - (C) describe a world that does not really exist
 - (D) are written mostly by Caribbean writers who live in exile
 - (E) describe things and activities that are outside of her everyday experience
25. The author uses capital letters for some words in the second paragraph (lines 6-15) primarily to
- (A) emphasize the ominous tone of the paragraph
 - (B) call attention to the idealized notions of the narrator as a young girl
 - (C) demonstrate the narrator’s youthful enthusiasm
 - (D) reveal the narrator’s lack of sophistication as a writer
 - (E) emphasize the narrator’s playful attitude as a young girl
26. The idea that “Books transported you always into Reality” (lines 13-14) is best described as
- (A) self-evident
 - (B) comical
 - (C) subversive
 - (D) paradoxical
 - (E) cliché

27. The creation of Helen reflects the narrator's
- (A) disenchantment with life on the island of Trinidad
 - (B) desire to become a creative writer
 - (C) sense that all people have alter egos
 - (D) need for a true friend and confidante
 - (E) eagerness to make amends with Tantie
28. In context, the expression "play the monkey" (line 37) likely means to
- (A) deny one's own humanity
 - (B) contort one's features
 - (C) act like a fool
 - (D) make fun of the elders
 - (E) try to amuse the family
29. It can be inferred from lines 34-39 ("But when . . . at-all'") that Tantie considers the narrator's behavior to be
- (A) weird and threatening
 - (B) amusing and harmless
 - (C) endearing and childlike
 - (D) silly and affected
 - (E) aberrant and condescending
30. The narrator rejects the term "double" (line 43) most likely because it
- (A) calls up a conflict she had tried to suppress
 - (B) implies an equality she did not experience
 - (C) denotes a similarity she was unwilling to acknowledge
 - (D) carries a responsibility she was not ready to face
 - (E) hints at a sentiment she was embarrassed to express
31. Which of the following would the narrator most likely identify as an example of the "wrongside" (line 49) ?
- (A) Having "read the two books by Monday morning" (lines 4-5)
 - (B) Eating "potatoes, not rice" (line 9)
 - (C) Using the word "'washicong' for plimsoll" (line 12)
 - (D) Spending "the summer holidays at the sea-side" (lines 17-18)
 - (E) Putting on shoes the moment she woke up (lines 29-30)
32. The word "loomed" (line 60) primarily suggests the narrator's feeling of
- (A) anger
 - (B) horror
 - (C) resignation
 - (D) despair
 - (E) insignificance

Questions 33-45. Read the following excerpt carefully before you choose your answers.

A little learning is a dangerous thing;
Drink deep, or taste not the Pierian spring.*
There shallow draughts intoxicate the brain,
And drinking largely sobers us again.
5 Fired at first sight with what the Muse imparts,
In fearless youth we tempt the heights of Arts,
While from the bounded level of our mind
Short views we take, nor see the lengths behind;
But more advanced, behold with strange surprise
10 New distant scenes of endless science rise!
So pleased at first the towering Alps we try,
Mount o'er the vales, and seem to tread the sky,
Th' eternal snows appear already past,
And the first clouds and mountains seem the last;
15 But, those attained, we tremble to survey
The growing labors of the lengthened way,
Th' increasing prospect tires our wandering eyes,
Hills peep o'er hills, and Alps on Alps arise!
A perfect judge will read each work of wit
20 With the same spirit that its author writ:
Survey the WHOLE, nor seek slight faults to find
Where nature moves, and rapture warms the mind;
Nor lose, for that malignant dull delight,
The generous pleasure to be charmed with wit.
25 But in such lays as neither ebb, nor flow,
Correctly cold, and regularly low,
That shunning faults, one quiet tenor keep,
We cannot blame indeed—but we may sleep.
In wit, as nature, what affects our hearts
30 Is not th' exactness of peculiar parts;
'Tis not a lip, or eye, we beauty call,
But the joint force and full result of all.
Thus when we view some well-proportioned dome,
(The world's just wonder, and even thine, O Rome!)
35 No single parts unequally surprise,
All comes united to th' admiring eyes;
No monstrous height, or breadth, or length appear;
The whole at once is bold, and regular.
Whoever thinks a faultless piece to see,
40 Thinks what ne'er was, nor is, nor e'er shall be.
In every work regard the writer's end,
Since none can compass more than they intend;
And if the means be just, the conduct true,
Applause, in spite of trivial faults, is due;

45 As men of breeding, sometimes men of wit,
T' avoid great errors, must the less commit:
Neglect the rules each verbal critic lays,
For not to know some trifles, is a praise.
Most critics, fond of some subservient art,
50 Still make the whole depend upon a part:
They talk of principles, but notions prize,
And all to one loved folly sacrifice.

(1711)

* a spring sacred to the Muses

33. In lines 1-18, mountain climbing is used primarily as
- (A) a metaphor for acquiring knowledge
 - (B) an analogy illustrating the struggle for self-knowledge
 - (C) a simile describing the relationship between human beings and nature
 - (D) an image of the difficulty of all human endeavor
 - (E) a symbol of the poet's own creative process
34. In lines 1-18, the speaker suggests that the more one knows
- (A) the more harmoniously one writes
 - (B) the more one finds there is to know
 - (C) the more creative one is likely to become
 - (D) the better one is able to evaluate art
 - (E) the fewer flaws one allows in one's work
35. According to lines 3-4, in order to become sober one should
- (A) refrain completely from further drinking
 - (B) drink only water from the spring
 - (C) study rather than drink
 - (D) drink only in small quantities
 - (E) drink a great amount
36. In line 5, "Fired" is best interpreted as meaning
- (A) tempted
 - (B) dismissed
 - (C) inspired
 - (D) fatigued
 - (E) bedeviled

37. At line 19, the subject matter shifts from
- (A) labor to amusement
 - (B) science to morality
 - (C) study to criticism
 - (D) nature to art
 - (E) pedantry to humor
38. In line 23, “that malignant dull delight” refers to
- (A) finding faults
 - (B) writing verse
 - (C) being witty
 - (D) reading poetry
 - (E) being entertained
39. The speaker makes a humorous comment in which of the following lines?
- (A) Line 11
 - (B) Line 17
 - (C) Line 21
 - (D) Line 28
 - (E) Line 31
40. Which of the following lines contains an example of the poetic device apostrophe?
- (A) Line 18
 - (B) Line 22
 - (C) Line 28
 - (D) Line 34
 - (E) Line 37
41. Lines 31-38 suggest that the appropriate way to appreciate a work of art is to consider its
- (A) nobility of purpose
 - (B) flawlessness
 - (C) wit
 - (D) balance and unity
 - (E) creativity and inspiration
42. In context, the word “end” (line 41) is best understood to refer to the
- (A) final lines of a work
 - (B) resolution of the plot
 - (C) author’s finished product
 - (D) author’s demise
 - (E) author’s aim in a work
43. Lines 41-42 suggest that an author
- (A) accomplishes more than he or she can imagine
 - (B) intends more than a critic can comprehend
 - (C) cannot anticipate how a work will affect readers
 - (D) cannot create what he or she cannot conceive
 - (E) need not write to please a critic
44. The speaker believes that the “verbal critic” (line 47) is
- (A) essentially objective in his or her evaluations
 - (B) a good guide for poets to follow
 - (C) overly concerned with trivial rules
 - (D) too idealistic to understand most real poetry
 - (E) essentially naïve
45. The speaker believes that the success of a work is achieved through
- (A) qualities not immediately perceptible on the surface
 - (B) the individual success of each of its component parts
 - (C) the harmony among its parts, in spite of their individual weaknesses
 - (D) the regularity of each of its component parts
 - (E) an author’s capacity to conceal its most serious flaws

Questions 46-55. Read the following passage carefully before you choose your answers.

Our ability to measure and apportion time affords an almost endless source of comfort.

Line 5 “Synchronize watches at oh six hundred,” says the infantry captain, and each of his huddled lieutenants finds a respite from fear in the act of bringing two tiny pointers into jeweled alignment while tons of heavy artillery go fluttering overhead: the prosaic, civilian-looking dial of the watch has restored, however briefly, an illusion of personal control. Good, it counsels, looking tidily up from the hairs and veins of each terribly vulnerable wrist; fine: so far, everything’s happening right on time.

10 “I’m afraid I’m booked solid through the end of the month,” says the executive, voluptuously nestling the phone at his cheek as he thumbs the leaves of his appointment calendar, and his mouth and eyes at that moment betray a sense of deep security. The crisp, plentiful, day-sized pages before him prove that nothing unforeseen, no calamity of chance or fate can overtake him between now and the end of the month. Ruin and pestilence have been held at bay, and death itself will have to wait; he is booked solid.

25 “Oh, let me see now,” says the ancient man, tilting his withered head to wince and blink at the sun in bewildered reminiscence, “my first wife passed away in the spring of—” and for a moment he is touched with terror. The spring of what? Past? Future? What is any spring but a mindless rearrangement of cells in the crust of the spinning earth as it floats in endless circuit of its sun? What is the sun itself but one of a billion insensible stars forever going nowhere into nothingness? Infinity! But soon the merciful valves and switches of his brain begin to do their tired work, and “The spring of Nineteen-Ought-Six,” he is able to say. “Or no, wait—” and his blood runs cold again as the galaxies revolve. “Wait! Nineteen-Ought—Four.” Now he is sure of it, and a restorative flood of well-being brings his hand involuntarily up to slap his thigh in satisfaction. He may have forgotten the shape of his first wife’s smile and the sound of her voice in tears, but by imposing a set of numerals on her death he has imposed coherence on his own life, and on life itself. Now all the other years can fall obediently into place, each with its orderly contribution to the whole. 45 Nineteen-Ten, Nineteen-Twenty—Why, of course he remembers!—Nineteen-Thirty, Nineteen-Forty, right on up to the well-deserved peace of his present and on into the gentle promise of his future. The earth can safely resume its benevolent stillness—Smell that

50 new grass!—and it’s the same grand old sun that has hung there smiling on him all these years. “Yes sir,” he can say with authority, “Nineteen-Ought-Four,” and the stars tonight will please him as tokens of his ultimate heavenly rest. He has brought order out of chaos. 55

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46. Which best describes the overall structure of the passage?
- (A) A pronouncement is made and its implications are addressed.
 - (B) A hypothesis is advanced and its accuracy is debated.
 - (C) A maxim is offered and its origins are described.
 - (D) A cliché is cited and systematically debunked.
 - (E) A claim is made and illustrated with multiple examples.
47. The narrator implies that keeping track of time provides
- (A) a useful reminder of the fragility of life
 - (B) a false sense of one’s power over the world
 - (C) an inducement to use one’s time more wisely
 - (D) an awareness that life involves constant change
 - (E) a continuous sense of progress and achievement
48. In context, “jeweled” (line 6) is best understood to connote
- (A) frivolous
 - (B) affluent
 - (C) radiant
 - (D) ostentatious
 - (E) delicate
49. The narrator’s tone in lines 21-22 (“Ruin . . . solid”) is best characterized as
- (A) wry
 - (B) reproachful
 - (C) didactic
 - (D) reverent
 - (E) despondent

50. The man is “touched with terror” (lines 26-27) because of his
- (A) need to relive a personal tragedy
 - (B) complicity in a shameful event
 - (C) fear of committing an unforgivable social gaffe
 - (D) failure to recall the timing of a notable occurrence
 - (E) feeling of imminent physical threat
51. Which best describes the series of questions and the exclamation in lines 27-32 (“The spring . . . Infinity!”) ?
- (A) They reflect an increasingly broad set of anxieties.
 - (B) They reveal a progressively more sophisticated outlook.
 - (C) They reflect a growing faith in human autonomy.
 - (D) They pinpoint several issues of universal concern.
 - (E) They pursue a line of reasoning to a flawed conclusion.
52. Which of the following is best understood to be ironic?
- (A) “each terribly vulnerable wrist” (line 11)
 - (B) “thumbs the leaves of his appointment calendar” (lines 15-16)
 - (C) “a mindless rearrangement of cells in the crust of the spinning earth” (lines 28-29)
 - (D) “his blood runs cold again as the galaxies revolve” (lines 35-36)
 - (E) “He has brought order out of chaos” (lines 54-55)
53. The reference to the “shape of his first wife’s smile and the sound of her voice in tears” (lines 39-41) suggests that
- (A) the man idealizes his first marriage
 - (B) the man regrets his treatment of his wife
 - (C) the man does not recall intimate details about his wife
 - (D) the man’s first wife was emotionally unstable
 - (E) the man’s first wife was a demanding presence in his life
54. In context, the interjection in lines 49-50 (“Smell that new grass!”) serves to
- (A) convey a renewed sense of optimism
 - (B) demonstrate respect for the natural world
 - (C) advocate a change in attitude
 - (D) give voice to a heartfelt request
 - (E) issue a stern command
55. The final sentence in each long paragraph (lines 9-12, lines 21-22, and lines 54-55) is best understood to
- (A) humorously implicate the reader in a belief
 - (B) gently mock a character’s sense of security
 - (C) obliquely note humankind’s true purpose
 - (D) ironically comment on humankind’s destructiveness
 - (E) enthusiastically celebrate the beauty of the world

ENGLISH LITERATURE AND COMPOSITION

SECTION II

Total time—2 hours

Question 1

(Suggested time—40 minutes. This question counts as one-third of the total essay section score.)

Carefully read the following poem by the poet and novelist John Updike. Then, using specific references to the poem's language and techniques, write a well-organized essay analyzing how Updike conveys the complex relationship between the novelist and the characters in the novel.

Marching Through a Novel

Each morning my characters
greet me with misty faces
willing, though chilled, to muster
Line for another day's progress
5 through the dazzling quicksand,
the marsh of blank paper.
With instant obedience
they change clothes and mannerisms,
drop a speech impediment,
10 develop a motive backwards
to suit the deed that's done.
They extend skeletal arms
for the handcuffs of contrivance,
slog through docilely
15 maneuvers of coincidence,
look toward me hopefully,
their general and quartermaster,
for a clearer face, a bigger heart.
I do what I can for them,
20 but it is not enough.
Forward is my order,
though their bandages unravel
and some have no backbones
and some turn traitor
25 like heads with two faces
and some fall forgotten
in the trenchwork of loose threads,
poor puffs of cartoon flak.
Forward. Believe me, I love them
30 though I march them to finish them off.

"Marching Through a Novel," from *Collected Poems 1953-1993* by John Updike, copyright © 1993 by John Updike.
Used by permission of Alfred A. Knopf, a division of
Random House, Inc.

Question 2

(Suggested time—40 minutes. This question counts as one-third of the total essay section score.)

The following passage is from Charlotte Brontë’s novel *Shirley* (1849). In the passage, the narrator describes the age of eighteen as an important threshold. In a well-organized essay, analyze how Brontë uses literary techniques to characterize the phases of life her protagonist is leaving and entering.

Line
5 Caroline Helstone was just eighteen years old; and at eighteen the true narrative of life is yet to be commenced. Before that time, we sit listening to a tale, a marvellous fiction; delightful sometimes, and
10 sad sometimes; almost always unreal. Before that time, our world is heroic; its inhabitants half-divine or semi-demon; its scenes are dream-scenes: darker woods and stranger hills; brighter skies, more dangerous waters; sweeter flowers, more tempting
15 fruits: wider plains, drearier deserts, sunnier fields than are found in nature, over-spread our enchanted globe. What a moon we gaze on before that time! How the trembling of our hearts at her aspect bears witness to its unutterable beauty! As to our sun, it is a burning heaven—the world of gods.

At that time—at eighteen, drawing near the confines of illusive, void dreams, Elf-land lies behind us, the shores of Reality rise in front. These shores are yet distant: they look so blue, soft, gentle, we long to
20 reach them. In sunshine we see a greenness beneath the azure, as of spring meadows; we catch glimpses of silver lines, and imagine the roll of living waters. Could we but reach this land, we think to hunger and thirst no more: whereas many a wilderness, and often
25 the flood of Death, or some stream of sorrow as cold and almost as black as Death, is to be crossed ere true bliss can be tasted. Every joy that life gives must be earned ere it is secured; and how hardly earned, those

30 only know who have wrestled for great prizes. The heart’s blood must gem with red beads the brow of the combatant, before the wreath of victory rustles over it.

At eighteen, we are not aware of this. Hope, when she smiles on us, and promises happiness to-morrow, is implicitly believed;—Love, when he comes
35 wandering like a lost angel to our door, is at once admitted, welcomed, embraced: his quiver is not seen; if his arrows penetrate, their wound is like a thrill of new life: there are no fears of poison, none
40 of the barb which no leech’s hand can extract: that perilous passion—an agony ever in some of its phases; with many, an agony throughout—is believed to be an unqualified good: in short, at eighteen, the school of Experience is to be entered, and her
45 humbling, crushing, grinding, but yet purifying and invigorating lessons are yet to be learnt.

Alas, Experience! No other mentor has so wasted and frozen a face as yours: none wears a robe so black, none bears a rod so heavy, none with hand
50 so inexorable draws the novice so sternly to his task, and forces him with authority so resistless to its acquirement. It is by your instructions alone that man or woman can ever find a safe track through life’s wilds; without it, how they stumble, how they stray!
55 On what forbidden grounds do they intrude, down what dread declivities are they hurled!

Question 3

(Suggested time—40 minutes. This question counts as one-third of the total essay section score.)

In many works of literature, relationships between siblings (brothers or sisters) create, clarify, or complicate central themes of the work. Choose a novel or play in which a sibling relationship—positive or negative—functions to deepen a central theme. Write a well-organized essay in which you analyze how the sibling relationship contributes to the meaning of the work as a whole. Do not merely summarize the plot.

You may select a work from the list below or choose another novel or play of comparable literary merit.

Absalom, Absalom!
All the King's Men
Antigone
Arcadia
Beloved
The Blind Assassin
The Bonesetter's Daughter
Brideshead Revisited
The Brothers Karamazov
The Catcher in the Rye
The Comedy of Errors
Crime and Punishment
Death of a Salesman
East of Eden
Fences
The Glass Menagerie
The Grapes of Wrath
The Homecoming
Housekeeping

The Importance of Being Earnest
Just Above My Head
King Lear
The Kite Runner
The Mill on the Floss
The Piano Lesson
The Poisonwood Bible
Pride and Prejudice
A Raisin in the Sun
Sister of My Heart
Song of Solomon
The Sound and the Fury
The Story of Edgar Sawtelle
A Thousand Acres
Three Sisters
Tom Jones
The Turn of the Screw
Wuthering Heights
A Yellow Raft in Blue Water

STOP

END OF EXAM

THE FOLLOWING INSTRUCTIONS APPLY TO THE COVERS OF THE SECTION II BOOKLET.

- **MAKE SURE YOU HAVE COMPLETED THE IDENTIFICATION INFORMATION AS REQUESTED ON THE FRONT AND BACK COVERS OF THE SECTION II BOOKLET.**
- **CHECK TO SEE THAT YOUR AP NUMBER LABEL APPEARS IN THE BOX(ES) ON THE COVER(S).**
- **MAKE SURE YOU HAVE USED THE SAME SET OF AP NUMBER LABELS ON ALL AP EXAMS YOU HAVE TAKEN THIS YEAR.**

**Answer Key for AP English Literature and Composition
Practice Exam, Section I**

Question 1: A	Question 29: D
Question 2: A	Question 30: B
Question 3: E	Question 31: C
Question 4: B	Question 32: E
Question 5: C	Question 33: A
Question 6: A	Question 34: B
Question 7: D	Question 35: E
Question 8: C	Question 36: C
Question 9: B	Question 37: C
Question 10: D	Question 38: A
Question 11: D	Question 39: D
Question 12: A	Question 40: D
Question 13: E	Question 41: D
Question 14: D	Question 42: E
Question 15: E	Question 43: D
Question 16: E	Question 44: C
Question 17: D	Question 45: C
Question 18: B	Question 46: E
Question 19: C	Question 47: B
Question 20: C	Question 48: E
Question 21: C	Question 49: A
Question 22: B	Question 50: D
Question 23: B	Question 51: A
Question 24: E	Question 52: E
Question 25: B	Question 53: C
Question 26: D	Question 54: A
Question 27: A	Question 55: B
Question 28: C	

AP[®] ENGLISH LITERATURE AND COMPOSITION

2014 SCORING GUIDELINES

Question 1

(John Updike's "Marching Through a Novel")

General Directions: This scoring guide will be useful for most of the essays that you read, but in problematic cases, please consult your table leader. The score that you assign should reflect your judgment of the quality of the essay as a whole—its content, style, and mechanics. **Reward the writers for what they do well.** The score for an exceptionally well-written essay may be raised by one point above the otherwise appropriate score. In no case may a poorly written essay be scored higher than a three (3).

9-8 These well-conceived essays offer a persuasive analysis of Updike's use of language and literary techniques to convey his ideas about the complex relationship between the novelist and the characters in the novel. Although the writers offer a range of interpretations and/or choose to address different literary devices (figurative language, tone, and structure), they provide convincing readings of how the poet's devices reflect his point of view. They demonstrate consistent and effective control over the elements of composition in language appropriate to the analysis of poetry. Their textual references are apt and specific. Though they may not be error-free, these essays are perceptive in their analysis and demonstrate writing that is clear and sophisticated, and in the case of a nine (9) essay, especially persuasive.

7-6 These competent essays offer a reasonable analysis of the poet's use of language and literary techniques to convey his ideas about the complex relationship between the novelist and the characters in the novel. They are less thorough or less precise in their discussion of how the poet's devices reflect his point of view, and their analysis of the poem is less convincing. These essays demonstrate the writer's ability to express ideas clearly with references to the text, although they do not exhibit the same level of effective writing as the 9-8 essays. While essays scored 7-6 are generally well-written, those scored a seven (7) demonstrate more sophistication in both substance and style.

5 These essays respond to the assigned task with a plausible reading of the poem, but they may be superficial in their understanding of how the poet uses language and literary devices to convey his ideas about the complexity that exists between the novelist and his characters. Their analysis of the poem may be vague, formulaic, or inadequately supported by references to the text. There may be minor misinterpretations of the poem. These writers demonstrate control of language, but the writing may be marred by surface errors. These essays are not as well-conceived, organized, or developed as 7-6 essays.

4-3 These lower-half essays fail to offer an adequate analysis of John Updike's poem. The analysis may be partial, unconvincing, or irrelevant. Evidence from the poem may be slight or misconstrued, or may rely on paraphrase only. The writing often demonstrates a lack of control over the conventions of composition: inadequate development of ideas, accumulations of errors, or an argument that is unclear, inconsistent, or repetitive. Essays scored a three (3) may contain significant misreading and/or demonstrate inept writing.

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2014 SCORING GUIDELINES

Question 1 (continued)

2-1 These essays compound the weaknesses of the papers in the 4-3 range. Although some attempt has been made to respond to the prompt, the writer's assertions are presented with little clarity, organization, or support from the poem. They may contain serious errors in grammar and mechanics. These essays may offer a complete misreading or be unacceptably brief. Essays scored a one (1) contain little coherent discussion of the poem.

0 These essays give a response that is completely off topic or inadequate; there may be some mark or a drawing or a brief reference to the task.

— These essays are entirely blank.

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2014 SCORING GUIDELINES

Question 2

(Charlotte Brontë's "Shirley")

General Directions: This scoring guide will be useful for most of the essays that you read, but in problematic cases, please consult your table leader. The score that you assign should reflect your judgment of the quality of the essay as a whole—its content, style, and mechanics. **Reward the writers for what they do well.** The score for an exceptionally well-written essay may be raised by one point above the otherwise appropriate score. In no case may a poorly written essay be scored higher than a three (3).

9-8 These essays offer a persuasive analysis of how Charlotte Brontë uses literary techniques to characterize the phases of life her protagonist is leaving and entering. The writers make a strong case for their interpretation of the passage. They recognize the narrator considers eighteen an important threshold, and they include in their analysis a variety of literary techniques, i.e. diction, imagery, tone, selection of detail, and syntax. The writers sustain their arguments through apt and specific references. Although these essays may not be error-free, their perceptive analysis is apparent in writing that is clear, precise, and effectively organized. Generally, essays scored a nine (9) reveal more sophisticated analysis and more effective control of language than do essays scored an eight (8).

7-6 These essays offer a reasonable analysis of how Charlotte Brontë uses literary techniques to characterize the phases of life her protagonist is leaving and entering. The writers provide a sustained, competent reading of the passage, with attention to such literary techniques as diction, imagery, tone, selection of detail, and syntax. Although these essays may not be error-free and may be less perceptive or less convincing than 9-8 essays, the writers present their ideas with clarity and control and refer to the text for support. Generally, essays scored a seven (7) present better developed and more consistent command of the elements of effective composition than do essays scored a six (6).

5 These essays respond to the assigned task with a plausible reading of the passage, but tend to be superficial or undeveloped in their treatment of how the author uses literary techniques to characterize the phases of life her protagonist is leaving and entering. While exhibiting some analysis of the passage, implicit or explicit, the discussion of how the author uses literary techniques may be slight, and support from the text may be thin or tend towards paraphrase. While these writers demonstrate adequate control of language, their essays may be marred by surface errors. Generally, essays scored a five (5) lack the more effective organization and more sustained development characteristic of 7-6 essays.

4-3 These essays offer a less than thorough understanding of the task and a less than adequate treatment of how the author uses literary techniques to characterize her protagonist's phases of life. Often relying on plot summary or paraphrase, the writers may misread the passage or fail to articulate a convincing understanding of the importance of turning eighteen. These papers may be characterized by an unfocused or repetitive presentation of ideas, an absence of textual support, or an accumulation of errors. Generally, essays scored a four (4) exhibit better control over the elements of composition than those scored a three (3).

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2014 SCORING GUIDELINES

Question 2 (continued)

2-1 These essays compound the weaknesses of the papers in the 4-3 range. They may persistently misread the passage or be unacceptably brief. They may contain pervasive errors that interfere with understanding. Although some attempt has been made to respond to the prompt, the writer's ideas are presented with little clarity, organization, or support from the passage. Essays scored a one (1) are especially inept or incoherent.

0 These essays give a response that is completely off topic or inadequate; there may be some mark or a drawing or a brief reference to the task.

— These essays are entirely blank.

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2014 SCORING GUIDELINES

Question 3

(Sibling Relationships)

General Directions: This scoring guide will be useful for most of the essays that you read, but in problematic cases, please consult your table leader. The score that you assign should reflect your judgment of the quality of the essay as a whole—its content, style, and mechanics. **Reward the writers for what they do well.** The score for an exceptionally well-written essay may be raised by one point above the otherwise appropriate score. In no case may a poorly written essay be scored higher than a three (3).

9-8 These well-focused and persuasive essays analyze how the sibling relationship, positive or negative, contributes to the meaning of the work as a whole. Using apt and specific textual support, these essays explore how the relationships between siblings create, clarify, or complicate the central themes of the work. Although not without flaws, these essays exhibit the writer's ability to discuss a literary work with significant insight and understanding, to sustain control over a thesis, and to write with clarity, precision, coherence--and in the case of a nine (9) essay, with particular persuasiveness and/or stylistic flair.

7-6 These competent essays analyze how the sibling relationship, positive or negative, contributes to the meaning of the work as a whole. These essays explain how the relationships between siblings create, clarify, or complicate the central themes of the work, but the analysis is less thorough, less perceptive, and/or less specific in supporting detail, than that of the 9-8 essays. References to the text may not be as apt or as persuasive. Essays scored a seven (7) demonstrate more sophistication in substance and in style than those scored a six (6), though both are generally well-written and free from significant or prolonged misinterpretations.

5 These essays respond to the assigned task, but tend to be superficial in analysis. They often rely upon plot summary that contains some analysis, implicit or explicit. Although the writers attempt to analyze how the sibling relationship contributes to the meaning of the work, they may demonstrate a rather simplistic understanding of the sibling relationship. Typically, these essays reveal unsophisticated thinking and/or immature writing. The writers demonstrate adequate control of language, but their essays lack effective organization and may be marred by surface errors.

4-3 These lower-half essays reflect an incomplete or oversimplified understanding of the work. While they may identify a sibling relationship in a novel or play, they fail to establish how that relationship functions to deepen a central theme. They may rely on plot summary alone and may not explain how the sibling relationship contributes to the meaning of the work. Their assertions may be unsupported or even irrelevant. Often wordy, vague, or repetitious, these essays lack control over the elements of college-level composition. Essays scored a three (3) may contain significant misreading and demonstrate inept writing.

2-1 Although these essays make some attempt to respond to the prompt, they compound the weaknesses of the papers in the 4-3 range. Often, they are unacceptably brief or incoherent in presenting their ideas. They are poorly written and contain distracting errors in grammar and mechanics. The writer's observations are presented with little clarity, organization, or supporting evidence. Inept, vacuous, and/or incoherent essays must be scored a one (1).

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2014 SCORING GUIDELINES

Question 3 (continued)

0 These essays give a response that is completely off topic or inadequate; there may be some mark or a drawing or a brief reference to the task.

— These essays are entirely blank.